

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 2, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 34:11-24

11 "For thus says the Lord God: 'Indeed I Myself will search for My sheep and seek them out.'"

12 "As a shepherd seeks out his flock on the day he is among his scattered sheep, so will I seek out My sheep and deliver them from all the places where they were scattered on a cloudy and dark day."

13 "And I will bring them out from the peoples and gather them from the countries, and will bring them to their own land; I will feed them on the mountains of Israel, in the valleys and in all the inhabited places of the country."

14 "I will feed them in good pasture, and their fold shall be on the high mountains of Israel. There they shall lie down in a good fold and feed in rich pasture on the mountains of Israel."

15 "I will feed My flock, and I will make them lie down," says the Lord God.

16 "I will seek what was lost and bring back what was driven away, bind up the broken and strengthen what was sick; but I will destroy the fat and the strong, and feed them in judgment."

17 "And as for you, O My flock, thus says the Lord God: 'Behold, I shall judge between sheep and sheep, between rams and goats.'"

18 "Is it too little for you to have eaten up the good pasture, that you must tread down with your feet the residue of your pasture—and to have drunk of the clear waters, that you must foul the residue with your feet?"

19 "And as for My flock, they eat what you have trampled with your feet, and they drink what you have fouled with your feet."

20 "Therefore thus says the Lord God to them: 'Behold, I Myself will judge between the fat and the lean sheep.'"

21 "Because you have pushed with side and shoulder, butted all the weak ones with your horns, and scattered them abroad,"

22 "therefore I will save My flock, and they shall no longer be a prey; and I will judge between sheep and sheep."

23 "I will establish one shepherd over them, and he shall feed them—My servant David. He shall feed them and be their shepherd."

24 "And I, the Lord, will be their God, and My servant David a prince among them; I, the Lord, have spoken."

II. Key Summary

- Through the prophet Ezekiel, God declares that because Israel's shepherds (leaders) failed to care for the flock, He Himself will step in to search for and rescue His sheep.
 - The passage describes God gathering the scattered sheep from every place, bringing them to rich pasture, binding up the injured, seeking the lost, while destroying the fat and strong sheep who trampled the pasture and fouled the water for the rest.
 - God promises to establish one shepherd over the flock—His servant David—to feed them, and He promises to be their God and make a covenant of peace with them.
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III. Passage Analysis

God comes looking for you Himself — He won't give up on you just because someone else dropped the ball

Since the kings failed in their duty, Israel's God Himself became the true shepherd of the people, searching for the scattered sheep... leading the exiled people back to their homeland and caring for them attentively. [1]

Adults in charge — leaders, parents, teachers — don't always take care of you the way they should, but this passage says God won't leave you on your own just because someone else failed at their job. He comes to find you and look after you Himself.

The shepherd God promises points forward to Jesus

And I will set up one Shepherd — that is, the Messiah, "the true Shepherd, who hath given himself this name both in the prophets and in the gospel, and who hath perfectly fulfilled all the duties, the characters whereof have been before described."
[2]

The "shepherd" named here really points to someone who was still to come — Jesus — with David's name just standing in for him. What God promises is care that lasts all the way through, not a one-time fix.

IV. Reflection Question

Do you ever feel like nobody actually notices what you're going through?

Ezekiel 34 says God promises to personally search for and heal the sheep that are hurt or lost — He pays attention to what's really going on with each one.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website (.org), Chain-Reference Bible Commentary (串珠聖經註釋), commentary on Ezekiel 34:11-16,
<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT34.htm>

[2] BibleHub.com, Benson's Commentary,
<https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/34-23.htm>